

11.6 Summary

In this chapter, we took a pattern that we've seen repeated throughout the book and we unified it under a single concept: monad. This allowed us to write a number of combinators once and for all, for many different data types that at first glance don't seem to have anything in common. We discussed laws that they all satisfy, the monad laws, from various perspectives, and we developed some insight into what it all means.

An abstract topic like this can't be fully understood all at once. It requires an iterative approach where you keep revisiting the topic from different perspectives. When you discover new monads or new applications of them, or see them appear in a new context, you'll inevitably gain new insight. And each time it happens, you might think to yourself, "OK, I thought I understood monads before, but now I *really* get it."